

A dark, blue-toned background image showing two individuals wearing VR headsets. They are positioned in front of a large, horizontal screen or display. The person on the left is partially visible, wearing a VR headset and a dark jacket. The person on the right is more central, also wearing a VR headset and a dark jacket, looking towards the screen. The overall scene suggests a collaborative virtual reality environment.

Secrets of Highly Effective Teams

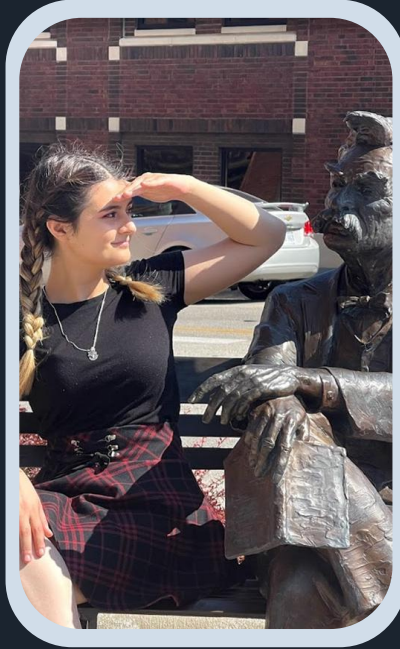
Leadership Fundamentals

A dark, blue-toned photograph of two individuals wearing VR headsets. The person on the left is wearing a white VR headset and a dark jacket, looking towards the right. The person on the right is wearing a white VR headset and a dark jacket, looking towards the left. They are both holding a large, flat, rectangular object, possibly a tablet or a piece of paper, in front of them. The background is dark and out of focus.

OUR MISSION:

“To bring people closer together through world-class immersive experiences.”





Danielle

- Program Manager - L&D
- Tenure - 3 years
- Amateur Unicyclist
- Pro Gardener
- “Voice” of all things Training

Pop Quiz!

PROJECT ARISTOTLE



- 180 Google teams over two years
- 200+ employee interviews, surveys, and work data
- 250 team attributes analyzed

Agenda

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Kickoff

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Aristotle's 3rd Principle

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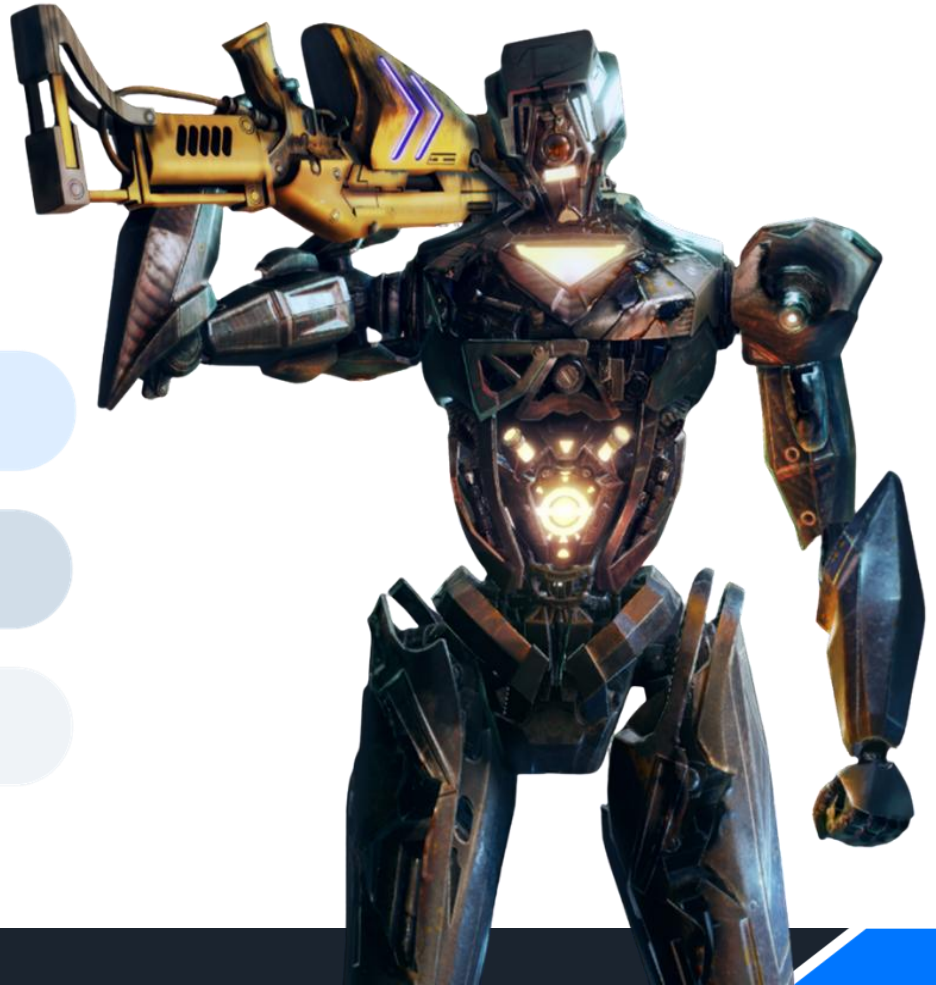
Summary & Next Steps

A Little About You!

Name

Years of leadership experience?

When was your first leadership opportunity?



Our Goals...



Explore Project
Aristotle's 5
Principles

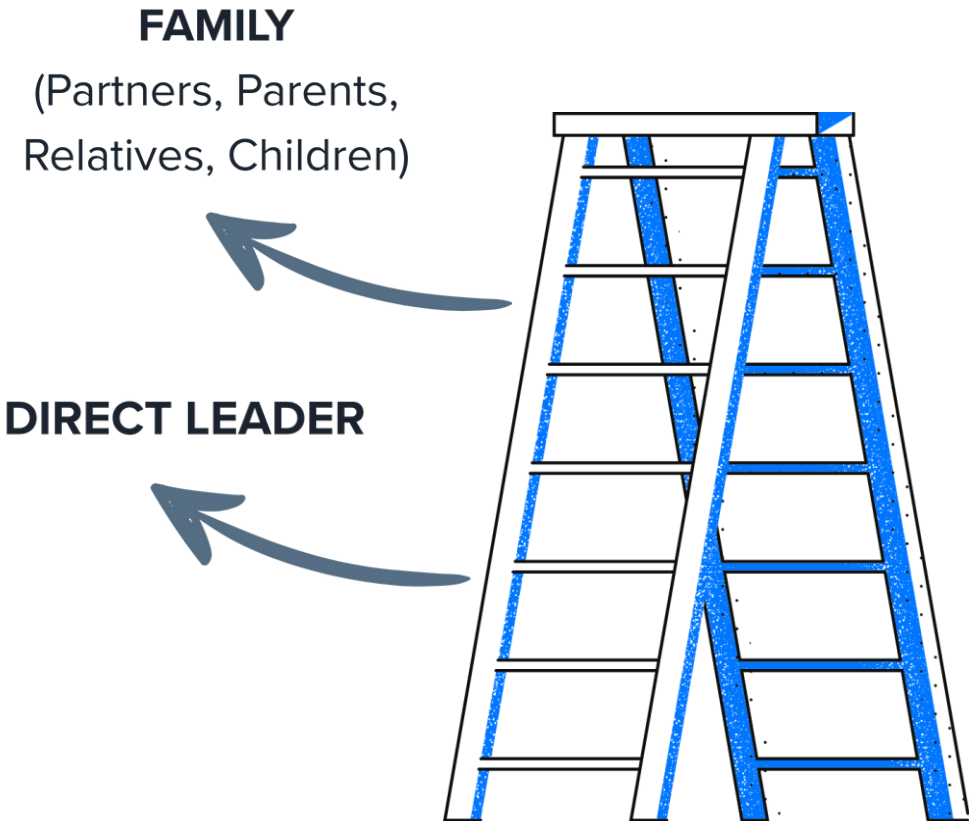


Apply these principles
to real-world
leadership



Share and reflect on
our Leadership
experiences

LARGEST INFLUENCES ON
MENTAL HEALTH



1. BAD BOSSES

- ✓ They say people quit not their jobs, but their bosses. And that's true on many accounts.



A study reveals **50%** of over **7000** employees

surveyed left their job



"to get away from their manager."



Deciding to leave a job is not something that most employees do lightly. So if they do, then you must be giving them a very good reason or several.



In order to keep the most talented people in your team, it's high time to look in the mirror and realise what you may be doing wrong in terms of factors, such as people management, task distribution, and goal and priority setting.

PREDICTORS OF QUITTING

1. BAD BOSSES



They say people quit not their bosses. And that's true on many occasions.

A study reveals **50%** of employees surveyed left their job

because of their bosses.



Deciding to leave a job, employees do lightly. They are often looking for a better opportunity.

In order to keep the most talented people, it's high time to look in the mirror and see if you're doing wrong in terms of factors, such as task distribution, and goal and priorities.

2. TOO MUCH WORKLOAD



When you have talented people on your team, it can be tempting to work them hard.

But, nothing burns an employee quite like giving them too much work.



While you may see this as giving recognition for great performance, overworking may feel like a punishment for your employees.



If you plan on increasing their workload, you better increase their job status, too.



Offer promotions, salary raises, and title changes in exchange for added responsibilities. Otherwise, expect them to seek new employers.

PREDICTORS OF QUITTING

1. BAD BOSSES 2. TOO MUCH WORK

- ✓ They say people quit not their jobs, but their bosses. And that's true on many accounts.
- ✓ When you have talented people in your team, it can be tempting to

A study reveals that about **50%** of over **7000** employees surveyed left their job

But, nothing turns an employee quite like giving them too much work. While you may see this as giving reward for great performance, overworking like a punishment for your employees "to get away from their manager."

If you plan on increasing their workload, you must increase their job satisfaction. Deciding to leave a job is not something the most employees do lightly. So if they do, then you must be giving them a very good reason or several.

In order to keep the most talented people in your team, it's high time to look in the mirror and realise what you may be doing wrong in terms of factors, such as people management, task distribution, and goal and priority setting.

3. NO RECOGNITION

82% of workers say that the lack of recognition towards their initiatives leads them to consider switching employers.

It is easy to downplay the power of rewarding and recognising your employees for outstanding work.



However, it is important to note that a simple pat on the back can have the biggest impact to employees, which is why managers need to communicate with their team to determine what it is that motivates them.



This may take the form of an internal recognition, a flexible schedule, a promotion, or an extra vacation time.

4. BROKEN COMMITMENTS



Making commitments to employees places you between making them happy and pushing them to quit their job.

When you follow through a commitment, it proves to the employee that you are honorable and trustworthy, thus, you grow in his eyes.



On the other hand, disregarding your promises makes you come across as disrespectful and uncaring, which significantly contributes to a worker's decision of leaving.

400%

LAWSUITS IN THE US HAVE
RISEN 400% SINCE 2000.

\$20,000

EVERY YEAR, BUSINESSES
>\$1 MILLION IN REVENUE
FACE AN EMPLOYEE LAWSUIT

60% OF US COMPANIES HAVE
FACED AN EMPLOYEE LAWSUIT
WITHIN THE LAST 5 YEARS.

Yep... **LEADING** is HARD.

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Aristotle's 1st Principle:
**Create Psych
Safety**

#1: Create Psych Safety

Psych Safety

"Trust that one can be openly vulnerable without getting embarrassed, rejected, or punished."



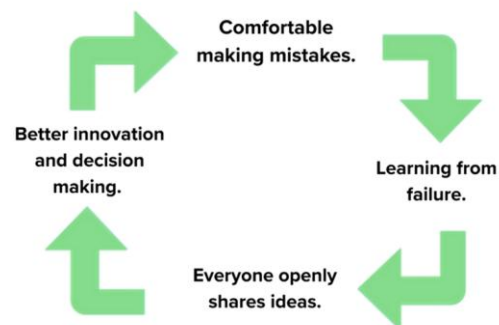
PSYCHOLOGICAL DANGER



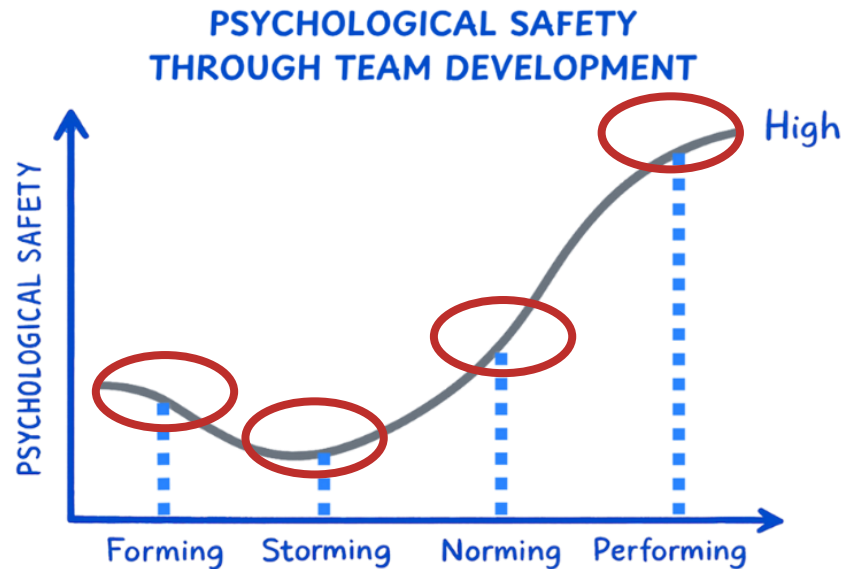
VS



PSYCHOLOGICAL SAFETY



#1: Create Psych Safety



- ✓ **Forming:** safety is low; people feel cautious
- ✓ **Storming:** safety must rise or team conflict will block progress
- ✓ **Norming:** safety improves; collaboration runs smoothly
- ✓ **Performing:** safety is high; team delivers and innovates

Have you ever felt **Psych
Danger** with a manager
before?

#1: Create Psych Safety



GREAT
1:1s



Are Team Member Led



Build Personal Relationships



Utilize Mutual Feedback & Active Listening

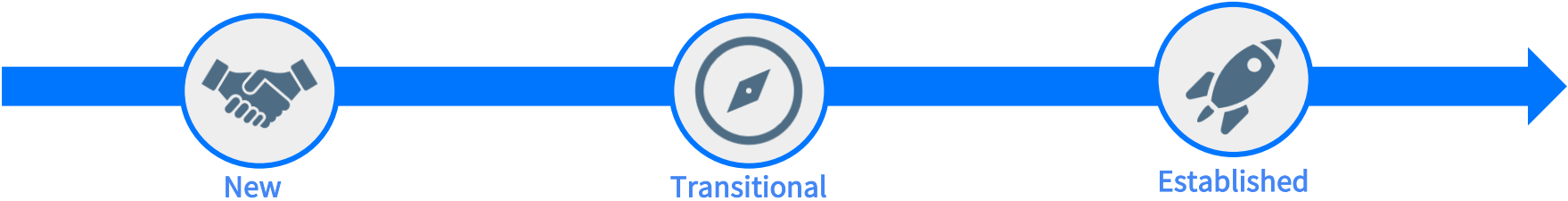


Balance Project Updates & Developmental Discussions

#1: Create Psych Safety

GREAT
1:1s

Great 1:1s Build Trust



What do you do in your free time?

How's onboarding?

What are you learning?

How can I best support you as your leader?

How do you like to give and receive feedback?

How's your current workload?

Noticing anything with the team?

How is [hobby] going?



Break: 15 minutes

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Aristotle's 2nd Principle:
**Make “Work”
Have Meaning**

#2: Make “Work” Have Meaning

Meaningful Work

*“When one finds personal **purpose** in the tasks they perform or in the **results** their team produces.”*

MOTIVATION ACCORDING TO HERTZBERG

Hygiene Factors (Preventative)

- ✗ Salary
- ✗ Working conditions
- ✗ Physical workspace
- ✗ Relationship with colleagues
- ✗ Relationship with supervisor
- ✗ Policies and rules



Improving these factors helps to reduce job dissatisfaction.

Motivating Factors (Boosters)

- ✓ Performance & achievement
- ✓ Recognition
- ✓ Job status
- ✓ Responsibility
- ✓ Opportunities for advancement
- ✓ Personal growth
- ✓ The work itself



Improving these factors helps to increase job satisfaction.

#2: Make “Work” Have Meaning

Hygiene Factors

- Fair pay
- Safe space
- Relationship with boss

Hygiene Factors (Preventative)

- ✗ Salary
- ✗ Working conditions
- ✗ Physical workspace
- ✗ Relationship with colleagues
- ✗ Relationship with supervisor
- ✗ Policies and rules



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- ✓ The work itself



Improving these factors helps to increase job satisfaction.

***These categories both exist at the same time, independently

#2: Make “Work” Have Meaning

Motivating Factors

- **Achievement**
- **Recognition**
- **Growth Path**

Hygiene Factors (Preventative)

- ✗ Salary
- ✗ Working conditions
- ✗ Physical workspace
- ✗ Relationship with colleagues
- ✗ Relationship with supervisor
- ✗ Policies and rules



Improving these factors helps to reduce job dissatisfaction.

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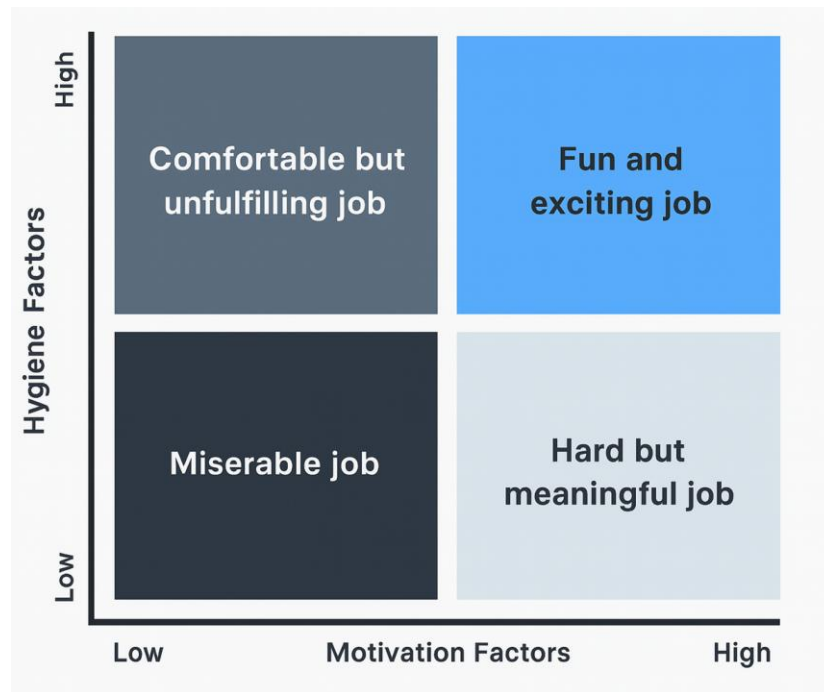


Improving these factors helps to increase job satisfaction.

****These categories both exist at the same time, independently*

#2: Make “Work” Have Meaning

(Preventative)



(Boosters)

****These categories both exist at the same time, independently*

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Aristotle's 3rd Principle:

Be A Dependable Leader

What Makes a Leader Dependable?

#3: Be A Dependable Leader

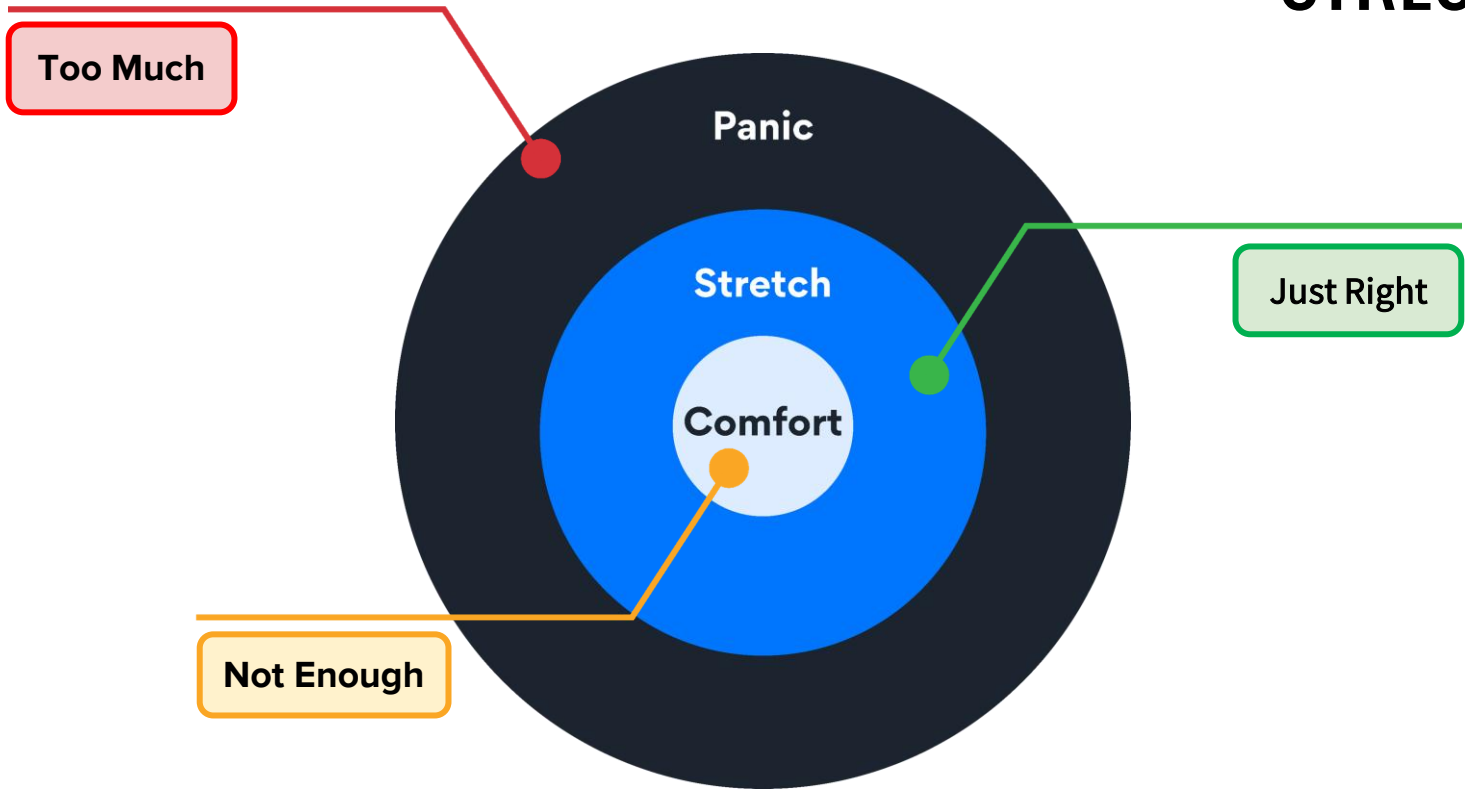
Dependable Leader

"A leader who honors their commitments, clears roadblocks, and clearly defines who owns what by when."

GROWTH VS STRESS

#3: Be A Dependable Leader

GROWTH VS
STRESS



#3: Be A Dependable Leader

GROWTH VS STRESS



- Defensiveness
- Aggression / Passive Aggression



- Topic Switching
- Missing Meetings
- Info Hunting



- “Whatever you want!”
- Over Agreeing



- Silence
- Analysis Paralysis

#3: Be A Dependable Leader

GROWTH VS STRESS



- Acknowledge
- Re-anchor goal



- Limit options
- Decide now



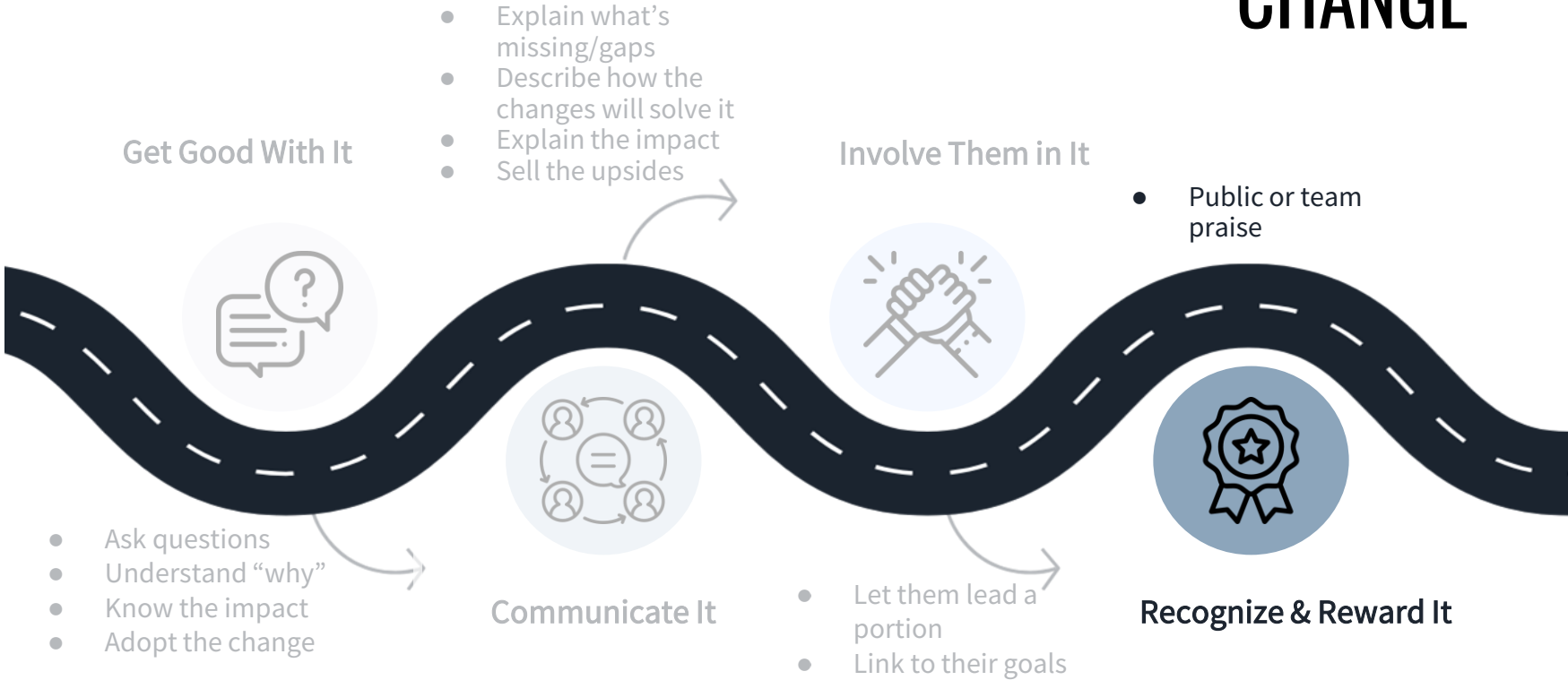
- Ask their recommendation
- Assign owner



- One next step
- Set deadline

LEADING THROUGH CHANGE

#3: Be A Dependable Leader



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Aristotle's 4th Principle:

Provide Structure & Clarity

Common Roads to Clarity

Clear Introductions

Do we have enough people for our current priorities? Are we giving them the onboarding they need?

Clear Priorities

Are we doing the right thing in the right order at the right time?

Clear Expectations

Am I being clear with my team on what I expect from them as individuals and as a group?

Common Roads to Clarity

Clear Introductions

Is our currently
prioritized work and
future work in need of
more people?

Clear Priorities

Are we doing the right
thing in the right order
at the right time?

Clear Expectations

Am I being clear with
my team on what I
expect from them as
individuals and as a
group?

What does a **good onboarding
experience** look like for your
team?

#4: Provide Structure & Clarity

Building a Great Onboarding Guide

- What do they need to be able to accomplish in **30/60** days?
- What **relationships** do they need to build?
- Who will train them? On what?
- How will you ensure the new TM feels **engaged**?
- How will you build their **confidence**?

CLEAR INTRODUCTIONS

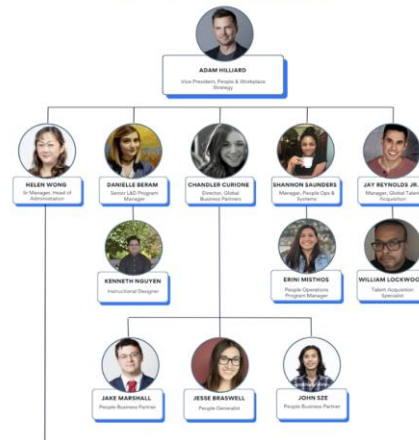
ONBOARDING & TRAINING PLAN SANDBOX^{VR}

WELCOME TO THE TEAM JESSE!

We are so excited to have you join the team! Your first day will be **July 16, 2025**. Please reference this Onboarding & Training Plan to guide you through your first few weeks.

Our aim is for you to connect with various team members across a diverse range of topics. This will help you get acquainted with the team and the business, setting you on the path to building strong relationships. Feel free to reach out to anyone on this list to schedule an introductory meeting. Use this opportunity to learn as much as you can and gain a clear understanding of how you will collaborate with each person.

KEY PEOPLE TO KNOW - YOUR PEOPLE TEAM (TEAM ORG)



#4: Provide Structure & Clarity



What Leads To Team Growth?



Upward movement of key players on your team



Need for new or additional skill sets



Major changes in our business needs / expansion of team responsibilities



Expected turnover

Common Roads to Clarity

Clear Introductions

Is our currently prioritized work and future work in need of more people?

Clear Priorities

Are we doing the right thing in the right order at the right time?

Clear Expectations

Am I being clear with my team on what I expect from them as individuals and as a group?

#4: Provide Structure & Clarity

CLEAR
PRIORITIES



#4: Provide Structure & Clarity

S



Specific

Who, What,
When Where,
Why?

M



Measureable

You can't
improve what
you can't
measure

A



Achievable

Challenging,
but not
impossible

R



Relevant

Closely
connected to
your dept. or
company
objectives

T



Timed

A completion
date holds
you
accountable

#4: Provide Structure & Clarity

“I Will Try Not to Eat Chocolate”

“I Want to Retire Now”

“I Wish to Get Promoted”

S



Specific

Who, What,
When Where,
Why?

M



Measurable

You can't
improve what
you can't
measure

A



Achievable

Challenging,
but not
impossible

R



Relevant

Closely
connected to
your dept. or
company
objectives

T



Timed

A completion
date holds
you
accountable

How Can We Improve These Goals?

Common Roads to Clarity

Clear Introductions

Is our currently prioritized work and future work in need of more people?

Clear Priorities

Are we doing the right thing in the right order at the right time?

Clear Expectations

Am I being clear with my team on what I expect from them as individuals and as a group?

#4: Provide Structure & Clarity

Communicating Expectations

- How do you **help people understand** what you expect of them individually
- What are **expectations** you have of them as a **group**?
- How should they **approach** work? **Handle** conflict? **Interact** with each other?

"My vision of an amazing _____ is someone who does the following"

CLEAR EXPECTATIONS

Team Expectation #5 - Not knowing the answer is ok. Telling people you don't know the answer, also ok. Guessing when you aren't sure, very not ok.

It's hard to be put on the spot as the "expert" and not know an answer. Fight that urge. At no point in my career have I ever seen anyone lose respect by telling someone "I don't know this answer, but I'll get back to you" so long as that person got back to them (see #1 above).

"Humble pie" in the moment tastes much better than "eating crow" after you make a major mistake. Our line of work is, in my opinion, one of the broadest and most complicated disciplines in all of corporate work. You should expect to get a lot of questions you don't know. I still get them all the time. There is respect to be gained by telling someone exactly what you know vs. w

What good
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Assessing Culture Impact: SBVR's Core Values



We Win Collectively

- Builds a positive reputation and relationship with others
- Communicates proactively and transparently
- Seeks input from others
- Offers help freely



We Embrace an Underdog Mindset

- Approaches challenges with resilience and adaptability
- Stays focused through change and setbacks
- Gets work done with limited resources, time, or direction
- Maintains a positive, can-do attitude



We Are Egoless

- Seeks and applies feedback with humility
- Acknowledges mistakes and takes ownership
- Demonstrates coachability and a growth mindset
- Performs all work without acting above any task

#4: Provide Structure & Clarity

Clear Expectations With Position Leveling

“This level of this role is expected
to _____”

Leveling Guidelines

**IC
“Track”**

P6 (Architect)

P5 (Principal)

P4 (Lead/Expert)

P3 (Senior)

P2 (Mid)

P1 (Associate)

**Manager
“Track”**

M6 (Sr. Director)

M5 (Director)

M4 (Sr. Mgr)

M3 (Manager)

**Executive
“Track”**

E4 (C-Suite)

E3 (Executive VP)

E2 (Senior VP)

E1 (Vice President)

Break: 15 minutes



Aristotle's 5th Principle:
**Enhance Your
Team's Impact**

Our Responsibility to Enhance Our Team's Impact



Feedback & Coaching



Performance
Management



Talent Development

#5: Enhance Your Team's Impact



Feedback

- Focuses on a **specific** behavior or outcome
- Often **reactive**—based on something that already happened
- Aims to **correct, reinforce, or clarify** performance
- Usually **short-form** and direct: “Here’s what I saw, here’s the impact”

Coaching

- Focuses on the person’s **development over time**
- Typically **proactive** and ongoing
- Aims to **build thinking, decision-making, and future capability**
- Involves **open-ended questions, reflection, and stretch goals**

What are some signs that your team is performing well? What about not performing well?

#5: Enhance Your Team's Impact



PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT



Role Impact:

Quantifiable impact on the business measured through **company outcomes** (within the technical expectations of their role)



Culture Impact:

Impact on the greater organization based on **"how"** they work, measured through our **Core Values**)

#5: Enhance Your Team's Impact

How We Rate Performance



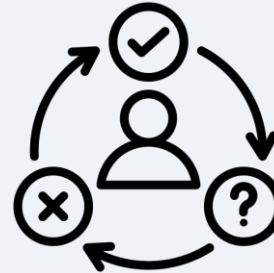
Outstanding

Consistent and strong overperformance or alignment for an entire evaluation period



Positive

Successfully meeting expectations in role



Mixed

Some positive, some negative, likely inconsistent or highly varied over time



Negative

Consistently poor outcomes

Scenario # 1

PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT

This person lives out many qualities of our core values. They're positive, collaborative, and humble. But their performance has never quite reached the level of the rest of the team. You've coached them on prioritization and follow-through, but improvements are minimal.

What do you do next?

Scenario # 2

PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT

A team member who is already on a performance **plan** for multiple detail-related errors (and previously told they are at risk of this leading to termination) **makes another serious mistake.**

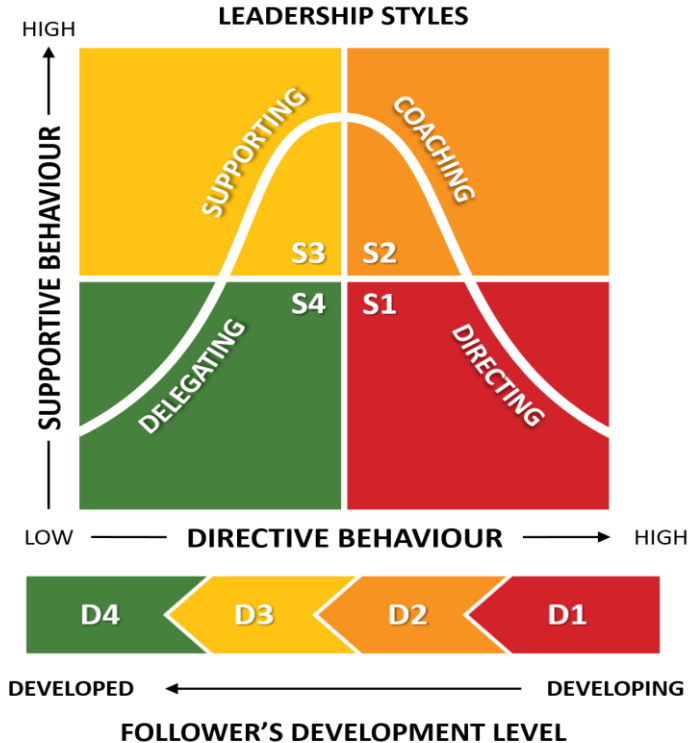
They're emotional, apologize immediately, and ask for one more chance to improve, saying they really want to stay.

What do you do next?

What is the difference between Performance Management and Talent Development?

#5: Enhance Your Team's Impact

TALENT DEVELOPMENT



Situational Leadership

Direction

- Shows an individual what, when, & how to do it
- Supervising and monitoring performance

Support

- Engaging in two-way communication
- Encourages & supports self-reliant problem solving
- Providing encouragement

#5: Enhance Your Team's Impact

New

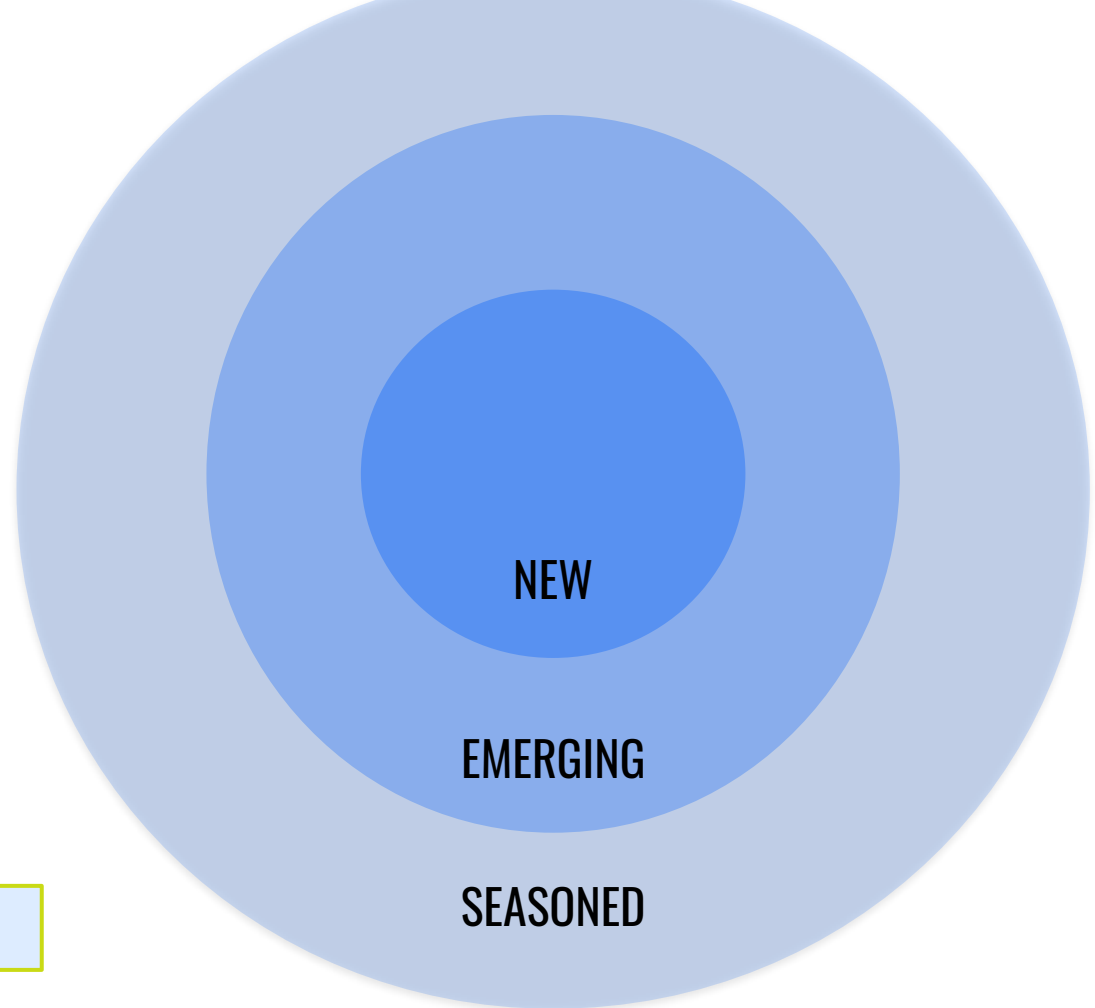
- Day 1 Culture Onboarding
- Store Training
- Technical Training
- Leadership Fundamentals

Emerging

- Internal 360s or E-Learning
- Cross-training / Stretch Goals

Seasoned

- Highly Situational



***Growth doesn't always mean a promotion

#5: Enhance Your Team's Impact



Managing Up



Does your leader know who are your strongest players?



Do they know your development goals for them?



Does your leader agree with your viewpoint?

Scenario # 1

TALENT DEVELOPMENT

You have a team member who is smart, reliable, and quick, but often comes to you for confirmation or asks you to take final action on their work. **You realize you're unintentionally becoming a bottleneck and limiting their development** into a more autonomous contributor.

What should you do?

Scenario # 2

TALENT DEVELOPMENT

You've been working with a high-potential team member who frequently asks for development opportunities and wants to move into a more senior role. **However, they consistently resist feedback** that requires them to adapt their communication style or collaborate differently.

What should you do?

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Our Goals...

Recapping what we accomplished today, thanks to you



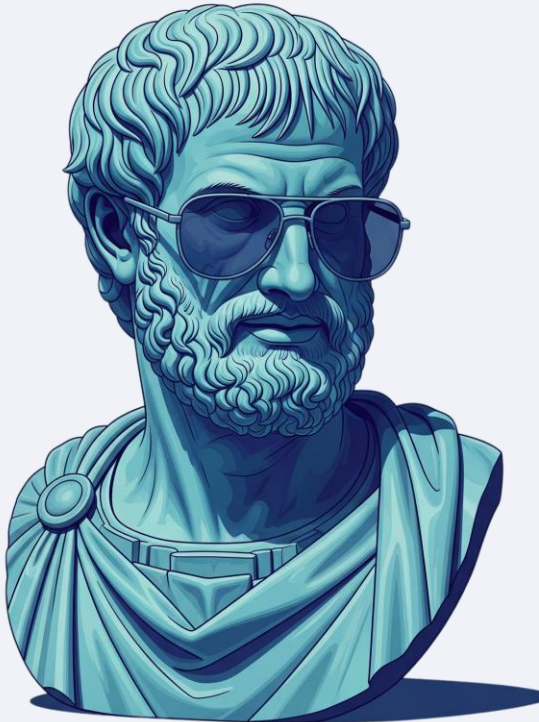
**Explore Project
Aristotle's 5
Principles**



**Apply these principles
to real-world
leadership**



**Share and reflect on
our Leadership
experiences**



What did you learn that **helped** you?

01 Create Psych Safety

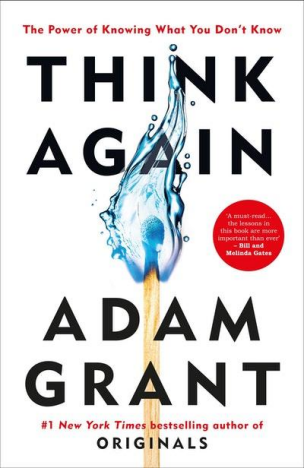
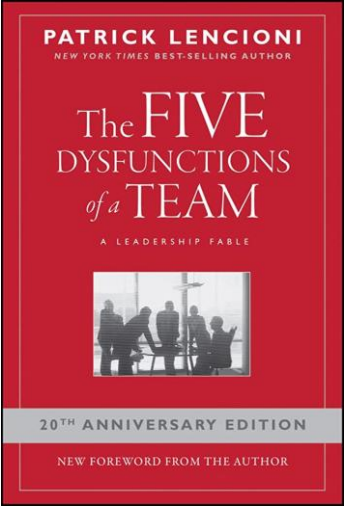
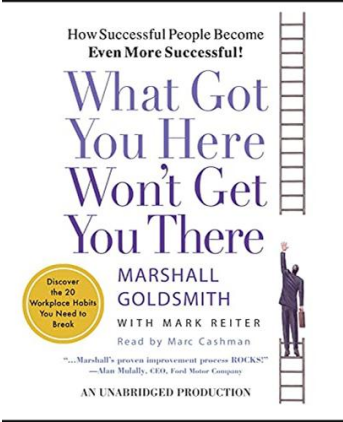
03 Be A Dependable Leader

02 Make “Work” Have Meaning

04 Provide Structure & Clarity

05 Enhance Your Team’s Impact

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Any **remaining** questions?

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Thank you!